

C2: OBSERVING THE CONTEXT

Entrepreneurship and Innovation Grade 10

Grade: _____
Date: _____
Name 1: _____
Name 2: _____
Name 3: _____

Our Goal

You have already identified several possible opportunities for improvement. Now, your team will select one opportunity and investigate what is actually happening in the context where it occurs.

The goal is not to confirm that your original idea is correct. The goal is to understand the situation better through direct and systematic observation.

At this stage, pay attention to what people do, what happens around them, how the environment affects the situation, and whether certain patterns appear repeatedly.

Select One Opportunity

Review the opportunities identified in Class 1. Select one situation that your team considers worth investigating further.

Element	Our selection
Opportunity	
Location	
People involved	
Why observe this situation?	

Important: Do not try to prove that the opportunity is real. Observe the situation openly and record what actually happens.

What to Observe

When observing the selected context, pay attention to different aspects of the situation:

- People
- Actions and behaviors
- Interactions
- Physical spaces
- Objects and materials
- Use of resources
- Movement and routines
- Waiting or interruptions
- Difficulties or obstacles
- Repeated situations

Look for what happens before, during, and after the situation you are investigating.

Rule: Record observations as evidence first. Interpretations can be added separately after you have collected the evidence.

Observation Method

Before beginning, decide how your team will observe the situation.

Element	Our observation plan
Where will we observe?	
When will we observe?	
What will we pay attention to?	
Who will record the observations?	
How will we record them?	

Remember: Observe without interfering with the situation whenever possible. Do not invent information that you cannot directly observe.

What to Record

For each observation, record enough information for another person to understand what happened.

Element	What to write	Example
Time	When did it happen?	8:05 a.m., beginning of Mathematics class (Sept. 10, 2026)
Location	Where did it happen?	Grade 10 classroom, immediately after the bell
People involved	Who was involved?	28 students and 1 teacher
Action	What happened?	After the bell, the teacher stopped the planned lesson to determine which students were present and record attendance.
Evidence	What did you directly see or hear?	The teacher spent approximately 5 minutes taking attendance before the lesson continued. In a 50-minute class, this represents 10% of the available class time.
Context	What else was happening?	Students arrived at slightly different times. The teacher had to look between the class list and the students in the room. One student arrived after attendance had already been recorded and the teacher had to update the record.
Pattern / Question	What might be worth observing again?	Attendance takes place during the transition between students entering the classroom and the beginning of the lesson. How much class time is spent on attendance, and which parts of the process require the most teacher attention?

Important: A useful observation is specific enough that someone else could understand what happened without having been there.

Observation

Time	
Location	
People involved	
What happened?	
Evidence: What did we see or hear?	
Context	
Interpretation / Question	

Identify Emerging Patterns

Review your observations. Look for situations that happened more than once or conditions that seem connected to the opportunity.

Question	Our findings
What happened more than once?	
When did the situation occur most often?	
Who was most affected?	
What contextual factors seemed relevant?	
What surprised us?	

A pattern is not just a guess. It should be supported by observations collected from the context.

Initial Reflection

1. What did you observe that you did not expect?

2. Which observation provides the strongest evidence about the situation? Why?

3. What pattern or repeated behavior did you notice?

4. What do you still need to observe or understand?

5. Did anything you observe challenge your original assumptions?

Final Check

- ☐ We observed a real context related to our selected opportunity.
 - ☐ We recorded specific observations rather than general opinions.
 - ☐ We identified the people, actions, and context involved.
 - ☐ We separated direct observations from interpretations.
 - ☐ We looked for repeated situations or emerging patterns.
 - ☐ We used evidence to support our observations.
 - ☐ We identified what we still need to understand.

First observe what happens. Then interpret what it might mean.